Sofia Almeida

Senior Backend Engineer | Distributed Systems
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior backend engineer with 14 years of experience designing high-throughput services, event-driven architectures and data platforms. Technical lead who has shipped payments, messaging and analytics systems serving millions of users.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Meridian Pay, Toronto 09/2022 – Present
Staff Engineer

- Architected a ledger service handling 9,000 transactions per second with 99.99% availability
- Led a team of 8 engineers across payments reconciliation and fraud tooling
- Introduced contract testing and canary deployments, reducing production incidents by 47%
- Drove adoption of OpenTelemetry tracing across 30+ services

Orbit Messaging, Toronto 03/2019 – 08/2022
Senior Software Engineer

- Rebuilt the notification pipeline on Kafka, scaling from 5M to 40M messages per day
- Reduced p99 delivery latency from 2.1 s to 420 ms
- Designed a multi-tenant rate-limiting service used by 200+ enterprise customers
- Mentored 6 engineers and ran the internal system-design reading group

Tallgrass Software, Ottawa 01/2016 – 02/2019
Software Engineer

- Developed Go microservices for an inventory platform serving 1,500 retailers
- Migrated a monolithic Java application to services with zero customer downtime
- Created internal CLI tooling that cut environment setup from 2 days to 30 minutes

Quillstone Data, Ottawa 06/2013 – 12/2015
Software Developer

- Built Python data-ingestion jobs for a market-research analytics product
- Optimized SQL queries, reducing report generation time by 65%
- Took part in the on-call rotation for production services

Maple Bridge Consulting, Waterloo 05/2012 – 05/2013
Junior Developer

- Implemented features for client web applications in Java and JavaScript
- Wrote unit and integration tests for billing modules

PROJECTS

- **distq (open source)** – Go library for distributed task queues on Redis, with 1.8K GitHub stars and 40 contributors.
- **kafka-lag-alerts (open source)** – Contributed alerting and dashboard features to a community Kafka monitoring tool used by 300+ teams.

EDUCATION

Northshore University – B.Eng., Software Engineering 2008 – 2012
Graduated with distinction

Westbridge University – M.Sc., Computer Science 2017 – 2019
Part-time

SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, SQL
Backend: gRPC, REST, GraphQL, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Microservices
Data: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, ClickHouse

Cloud and DevOps: AWS, GCP, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Prometheus, Grafana

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional
- Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)

LANGUAGES

English, Portuguese, French (basic)